First, we create an array of strings, `$turkishFriends`, and use Unicode escapes for the names that have Turkish characters (and PHP's default encoding is UTF-8, so these will be multi-byte characters). The first sort – `usort($turkishFriends, 'strcmp');` – will sort the array using the no-frills binary comparison of `strcmp()`. Predictably enough, we end up with the wrong collation; the names beginning with Turkish characters have been sorted to the end of the array.

Next, we call `setlocale(LC_COLLATE, 'tr_TR.UTF-8');`, which tells PHP that when we perform collation, we wish to use the rules for the "tr_TR.UTF-8" locale. If that locale is installed on the system (which is the case for the Docker images for this book), then when we call `usort()` with `'strcoll'` specified as the comparison function, the order is correct. (If you are following along at home and using the Docker images that can be built from this book's GitHub repository, those images have the "tr_TR.UTF-8" locale installed and enabled already.)

`strcoll()` is a venerable old thing; it has been with us since the dark days of PHP 4, and it is also dependent on the underlying operating system to function correctly. A more modern approach to localized collation is the `Collator` class, which is part of PHP's `intl` module and is compiled against `libicu`. It is independent of the operating system and recommended over juggling `setlocale()` and `strcoll()`.

Similarity

Table 8-9. *String similarity functions*

`levenshtein()`	Calculate Levenshtein distance between two strings
`metaphone()`	Calculate the metaphone key
`similar_text()`	Count matching chars
`soundex()`	Calculate the soundex key

`metaphone()`, `soundex()`

Sometimes, when two strings are not precisely equal, it is useful to know the degree of similarity between them. There are two general forms of analysis available in PHP. One technique examines the phonetic properties of strings, for which there are two similar functions (implementing different algorithms): `metaphone()` and `soundex()`.